

developers is evident. Linux-based users swear by ‘GIMP’, the GNU Image Manipulation Program which is freely distributed and is now available on Windows and OSX platforms as well.

Audio editing tools

Audio editing still remains a fairly niche area in comparison to video and image editing. The market leading software in audio editing are age old companies such as Apple, Avid and Adobe, and are referred to as ‘Digital Audio Workstation’ software in the professional setting. Avid’s Pro Tools have been used widely in movies and music albums to record and edit some of the most famous musical compositions of the modern age. While Apple’s GarageBand is an amateur favourite due to its easy-to-use features to record, synthesise and edit digitally generated musical instrument sounds. Adobe, with its Soundbooth and Audition applications, has a relatively small slice of the pie as it arrived late on the scene, but makes up with its great depth of features and dynamic linking options with the rest of the multimedia editing suite which includes video editors Premiere Pro and After Effects.

Apart from these industry standard software, there are other options that have become more popular in the recent years mainly due to their cost effectiveness. Applications such as ‘MAGIX Music Maker’, ‘WavePad’ and ‘AVS Audio Editor’, along with dark horses such as Sony’s ‘Acid Pro’ and ‘FL Studio’ (a.k.a. ‘FruityLoops’) offer interesting alternative choices. There are, of course, a wider range of options apart from these paid for options that we’ll explore in greater detail soon. Software like ‘Audacity’ and ‘Waveosaur’ offer similarly useful features at no cost and will do the job, in most cases, of casual everyday editing.

Paid vs. Free Applications

As with all realms of the digital world there exists the widest possible range of options for users – from amateur basic tools to industrial scale professional tools, open source software to proprietary iron clad software, and most importantly premium priced options to completely free options. Each of these comes with its own set of pros and cons.

As is the case with any product or service, a higher cost product doesn’t necessarily mean higher value; many times the best options are the free ones. However, user expectations can form a great dissonance in what “value” really means. If you want a video/special effects editor for free that can help you make the next *Guardians of the Galaxy*, then you’re just fooling